VISHNU BHAIYA- A BOND OF TRUST
STANDING STRONG WITH HIS SISTERS

The story of Chhattisgarh's Mahtari Vandan Yojana begins with monthly assistance of ₹1,000, but its impact extends beyond the financial support it provides. Launched on March 10, 2024, the 31st instalment under the scheme was released on August 25, 2026. The latest instalment of ₹631.38 crore has taken the total amount transferred under the scheme to more than ₹20,000 crore. The funds have been transferred directly into the bank accounts of eligible women through Direct Benefit Transfer.



Implemented under the leadership of Chief Minister Vishnu Deo Sai, the State Government views the scheme as an initiative aimed at strengthening women's dignity, self-reliance and economic empowerment. The observance of 2026 as 'Mahtari Gaurav Varsh' further reflects this commitment.

The real impact of the scheme, however, is visible not merely in the numbers but in the stories of women who have used small amounts of financial assistance as the foundation for bigger decisions. Women such as Tej Kumari, Manju Rajwade, Puniya Prajapati, Shahnaz Begum, Ganeshwari Prajapati, Menka Rajwade and Lata Kenwat from Surajpur are using the assistance for their children's education, school supplies, nutritious food and everyday household needs. For them, the money is not simply a means to meet expenses; it also gives them a sense of having a greater financial role within their families.

In Ghuthera village of Mungeli, Anita Gandharv chose to save the money she received through the scheme rather than spend it immediately. Over time, those savings helped her set up a small general and cosmetics store along with a tailoring shop in the Old Bus Stand area of Mungeli. What began with limited resources now enables her to earn around ₹500 to ₹1,000 a day. By contributing to her children's education and household expenses, Anita has taken a significant step towards economic independence.

Shabina Begum of Janjgir-Champa offers another example of how small financial support can grow into a livelihood. She had been running a modest bangle shop from home. Using the money received under Mahtari Vandan, she expanded the range of bangles and added new products. As the variety increased, so did the number of customers, strengthening her contribution to the family's finances.

For Gayatri Srivastava of Manendragarh-Chirmiri-Bharatpur, regular instalments made it possible to save enough to purchase a second-hand sewing-and-pico machine. Earlier, she had to get pico work done elsewhere. With her own machine, she began offering the service alongside tailoring. One machine thus expanded both the scope of her work and her earning potential.

For Hemant Banjare of Sakti, the monthly assistance has helped manage household needs and everyday expenses. Devki Nishad of Mohla says it has strengthened her ability to contribute towards her children's education and other family needs. Anita Gupta of Manendragarh-Chirmiri-Bharatpur uses the assistance to purchase stock for her small shop as well as meet household expenses.

The emotional and social dimension of this bond was visible during the 'Sneh Ki Dor' programme organised in Raipur on the occasion of Raksha Bandhan. Schoolgirls, daughters with special ability and members of women's self-help groups tied rakhis on the wrists of personnel from the armed forces, Central Armed Police Forces and police. A particularly significant moment came when Madhuri Verma, wife of Sub-Inspector Yugal Kishore Verma, who was killed in a Naxal encounter in 2017, tied a rakhi on Chief Minister Vishnu Deo Sai's wrist.





> **"When mothers and sisters are economically empowered, families become stronger, children's futures become more secure, and society moves forward on a new path of development."**
>
> **Vishnu Deo Sai**
> **Chief Minister, Chhattisgarh**

The release of the instalment ahead of Raksha Bandhan also led women from different parts of the state to express their gratitude to the government. From Sukma to Koriya and Rajnandgaon to Raigarh, women spoke of how regular financial assistance had eased everyday pressures and strengthened their confidence in making economic decisions.

Perhaps the most significant strength of Mahtari Vandan is its continuity. Thirty-one instalments have given women the confidence of having a regular financial resource—something they can spend, save and, wherever possible, invest. The government views the scheme as an initiative to strengthen women's dignity, self-reliance and economic empowerment.

Ultimately, the story of Mahtari Vandan goes beyond the monthly assistance of ₹1,000 and more than ₹20,000 crore transferred so far. It is a story of transformation: how a small amounts of financial assistance as the foundation for greater opportunities, how an opportunity can create the confidence that comes from having a regular source of financial support, and how that confidence can open the door to self-reliance.

And somewhere along this journey, a government scheme has also taken on the warmth of a personal bond—one in which Lakhs of women in Chhattisgarh have come to see Chief Minister Vishnu Deo Sai not merely as their Chief Minister, but as their 'Bhaiya'.